

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 9
Another Kind of Freedom ~ Radical Love
2 August 2026

Preaching: ML

Worship Leading: LVF & Megan Mascena

David's & Laurel's Last Sunday

Strips of paper in programs for prayers

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Abe Ross, *Guest Organist*

Chiming of the Hour

[Laura and Megan center chancel]

Welcome

LVF

Words of Gathering

MM & LVF

***Hymn of Gathering**

[Laura center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness**

LVF

[All turn towards choir]

***Introit**

[Megan to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

MM

Our Holy Scriptures tell us that we are all created in the image and likeness of God.

In this place, we celebrate the Mystery of who God is. We remember that our tradition is rich in calling The Divine by many names: Holy One, Loving Mother, Compassionate Father, Source of Life, Redeemer, Loving Presence, and El-Roi, the God who sees.

Because of this Mystery, we invite you to pray The Lord's Prayer in your own tradition and language. In this way, we celebrate the interconnectedness of our lives, whether we come from near or from far. Let us now pray together as Jesus taught us...

*Our [God], who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy Name,
thy kingdom come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our debts,
as we forgive our debtors.
And lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kingdom,
and the power, and the glory,
forever.
Amen.*

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Laura to center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

LVF

Please be seated

[Megan to lectern]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition *from the Gospel of Luke* MM

Speaking to a great number of disciples and a large crowd of people from all over the region, Jesus shared these words of wisdom, written in the Gospel of Luke, chapter 6...

“To you who hear me, I say: love your enemies. Do good to those who hate you, bless those who curse you, and pray for those who mistreat you. When they slap you on one cheek, turn and give them the other; when they take your coat, let them have your shirt as well. Give to all who beg from you. When someone takes what is yours, don't demand it back.

“Do to others what you would have them do to you. If you love those who love you, what credit does that do you? Even those who choose to harm others, love those who love them. If you do

good only to those who do good to you, what credit does that do you? Even those who choose to harm others do as much.

“If you lend to those you expect to repay you, what credit does that do you? Even those who choose to harm others lend to others expecting to be repaid in full. Love your enemies and do good to them. Lend without expecting repayment, and your reward will be great. You’ll rightly be called children of the most high, since God is good even to the ungrateful and the wicked.

“Be compassionate, as your loving God is compassionate. Don’t judge, and you won’t be judged. Don’t condemn, and you won’t be condemned. Pardon, and you’ll be pardoned. Give, and it will be given to you: a full measure—packed down, shaken together and running over—will be poured into your lap. For the amount you measure out is the amount you’ll be given back.”

This is the Gospel of Radical Love.
Thanks be to God!

[Abe short transition Laura center chancel]

Prayers with the People

LVF

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

As we come to this time of silence and prayer, we are invited once again to remember that we are not alone. Whether we come from near or far, we are wrapped in a love that has the power to turn enemies into friends and friends into family.

As we breathe in the peace that surrounds us in this space we make holy by our presence together, we pray that the Divine will remind us we are all the people who carry the image of God within us, around us, and among us.

Writing prayers

Let us now be in silence, together.

Silence

[Abe transition out of silence as people come forward to offer prayers and light candles]

[Laura center chancel when all are seated]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Abe transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Abe transition Michael to pulpit, choir to seats]

Sermon

Radical Love

ML

[Abe transition Megan to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

MM

Offertory Anthem

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Megan to lectern toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer**

MM

God of Grace and Love, remind us as we leave this time together,
that you made us in your image
and filled us with your Spirit of Love.

As we offer all our gifts and talents, O God,
give us the vision to use your wildly inclusive love,
so that by our words and our actions,
we may dismantle the walls of division
and co-create our lives with your grace and love,
on this day and on all the days to come.

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

Amen and Amen.

Please be seated

[Laura & Michael center chancel]

Life at First Church

ML & LVF

-Recognition of David and Laurel

Words of Blessing

ML

Choral Response

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Laura center chancel]

Postlude

Inside The Music